bricks being handmade and of different sizes, suggesting the absence of mass production.

‘Mauryan’ does not of course mean ‘Ashokan’: gaps in our understanding of Gotihawa persist. There are no such doubts about the other monumental element here—a pillar, or, to be more precise, the broken portion of a pillar which stands south-west of the stupa. Set up by Ashoka, only the lower part has survived, causing the inscription, if any, to have disappeared. Unlike a number of Ashokan pillars such as that at Lumbini and at Sarnath where the lower parts are rough (since these were meant to be embedded), the Gotihawa stump is finished from the base itself.[40] The tapering is similar to that of the one at Lumbini. The foundation slab bears a simple geometric rendering of the hill-and-crescent symbol, which is considered typically Mauryan.[41]



Fig. 10.7: Nigali Sagar pillar segments